QP: 25901883

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026

second SEMESTER

SDC - MG2SDCTHM102 - TRAVEL AGENCY AND TOUR OPERATIONS BUSINESS

Part A Short Answer Answer

any 5 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. **List any two basic requirements for setting up a travel agency.** [K] / [CO1]
    - Office setup with communication facilities
    - Registration and license from tourism authorities
2. **How does a clear itinerary improve customer satisfaction?** [U] / [CO4]
    - A clear itinerary helps travelers understand the schedule, avoid confusion, and manage time properly during the trip.
3. **Define the term visa.** [K] / [CO2]
    - A visa is an official permission issued by a country allowing a person to enter, stay, or travel within that country for a specific period.
4. **State the role of VFS Global in assisting clients with visa documentation.** [A] / [CO4]
    - VFS Global assists applicants by collecting visa applications, verifying documents, and scheduling biometric and interview appointments for embassies.
5. **Mention any two responsibilities of a travel agent towards clients.** [A] / [CO4]
    - Providing correct travel information
    - Arranging tickets, accommodation, and travel services
6. **Mention any two elements of an itinerary.** [K] / [CO3]
    - Travel schedule
    - Accommodation details
7. **Define package tour in the context of travel agency business.** [K] / [CO1]
    - A package tour is a pre-arranged travel plan that includes transport, accommodation, sightseeing, and other services for a fixed price.

Part B

Short Answer Question Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 5 marks

8. Describe the methods of visa verification and explain their importance in international travel. [U] / [CO2]
Visa verification is the process of checking the authenticity and validity of a visa. Common methods include:

- Checking passport and visa details manually
- Online verification through embassy or immigration portals
- Biometric verification such as fingerprints and photographs
- Barcode or QR code scanning at airports

Importance:

- Prevents illegal entry and fraud
- Ensures traveler security and compliance with immigration laws
- Helps smooth international travel procedures

9. Explain any two types of coverage in travel insurance. [K] / [CO2]

1. **Medical Coverage** – Covers hospital expenses, medical emergencies, and accidents during travel.
2. **Trip Cancellation Coverage** – Provides compensation if the trip is cancelled due to emergencies such as illness or natural disasters.

10. Analyse the importance of time scheduling while preparing an itinerary. [An] / [CO3]
Time scheduling helps in proper management of travel activities and avoids delays. It ensures that travelers can visit destinations comfortably without confusion. Proper scheduling improves coordination of transport, accommodation, meals, and sightseeing, leading to a smooth and enjoyable travel experience.

11. Discuss the role of a Ground Tour Operator. [A] / [CO3]
A Ground Tour Operator manages travel services at the destination. Their roles include:

- Arranging local transport and accommodation
- Organizing sightseeing and guides
- Assisting tourists during the tour
- Coordinating with travel agencies and hotels

They ensure smooth operation of tours at the local level.

12. Explain the meaning of choice of destination in travel planning. [U] / [CO1]
Choice of destination refers to selecting a suitable place for travel based on factors such as budget, purpose of travel, climate, attractions, safety, and traveler interests. It is an important step in planning a successful tour.

13. Write a short note on passport-size photographs required for visa. [K] / [CO2]
Passport-size photographs are essential documents required for visa applications. The photographs must follow specific embassy guidelines regarding size, background color, facial expression, and recent appearance. Incorrect photographs may lead to rejection or delay of visa processing.

14. Write a short note on passport renewal procedure. [K] / [CO2]

Passport renewal is the process of extending the validity of an expired or expiring passport. The procedure generally includes:

- Filling out the passport renewal application form
- Submitting old passport and required documents
- Providing photographs and identity proof
- Paying the renewal fee
- Attending verification if required

Part C

Long Essay Questions Answer any 1 questions Each question carries 15 marks

15. Prepare a detailed note on visa formalities for any two countries. [C] / [CO3]

Visa Formalities for Singapore

Singapore visa procedures are simple and systematic. Indian travelers require a valid visa before entering Singapore for tourism or business purposes.

Main Requirements:

1. Valid passport with minimum six months validity
2. Completed visa application form
3. Recent passport-size photographs
4. Confirmed return air ticket
5. Hotel reservation details
6. Bank statement as proof of financial support

7. Covering letter mentioning purpose of visit
8. Travel insurance (recommended)

Application Procedure:

- Visa applications are submitted through authorized visa agents or online systems.
- Documents are verified and biometric details may be collected.
- Processing usually takes 3–5 working days.
- After approval, an e-visa is issued.

Importance:

- Ensures legal entry into the country
- Helps immigration authorities maintain security and control
- Facilitates smooth travel procedures

Visa Formalities for Malaysia

Malaysia also requires Indian citizens to obtain a visa before travel.

Main Requirements:

1. Valid passport
2. Completed visa application form
3. Passport-size photographs
4. Confirmed flight tickets
5. Proof of accommodation
6. Financial proof such as bank statements
7. Travel itinerary
8. Visa fee payment receipt

Application Procedure:

- Applications can be submitted online or through visa centers.
- Necessary documents are checked by the visa authority.
- Applicants may be asked for biometric verification.
- Once approved, the visa is stamped or issued electronically.

Importance:

- Prevents illegal immigration
- Maintains international travel regulations

- Protects national security and traveler safety

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16. Evaluate the contribution of commission, service charges, and tour packaging to the income of a Travel Agency. [E] / [CO1]

A travel agency earns income from different sources such as commission, service charges, and tour packaging. These are important for the financial success of the agency.

1. Commission

Commission is the amount paid to travel agencies by airlines, hotels, cruise companies, and tour operators for selling their services.

Contribution:

- Major source of traditional income
- Encourages agencies to promote tourism products
- Earned from hotel bookings, flight tickets, insurance, and transport services

Advantages:

- Regular income without investing in products
- Builds business relationships with suppliers

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2. Service Charges

Service charges are fees collected directly from customers for professional services provided by the agency.

Contribution:

- Helps agencies earn even when commissions are low
- Covers consultation and operational expenses
- Increases profitability

Examples:

- Visa processing fees
- Itinerary preparation charges
- Ticket cancellation charges
- Documentation assistance fees

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3. Tour Packaging

Tour packaging means combining transport, accommodation, meals, sightseeing, and other services into a single package sold at a fixed price.

Contribution:

- Generates higher profit margins
- Attracts more customers due to convenience and cost savings
- Helps agencies market customized tours

Advantages:

- Better control over pricing
- Opportunity for bulk booking discounts
- Improves customer satisfaction

Conclusion

Commission, service charges, and tour packaging together form the backbone of travel agency income. Modern travel agencies increasingly depend on service charges and customized tour packages due to reduced airline commissions and growing competition in the tourism industry.

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17. Prepare a detailed outbound itinerary for Singapore including all major travel arrangements.

Outbound Tour Itinerary – Singapore [C] / [CO3]

Singapore

Duration:

5 Days / 4 Nights

Mode of Travel:

Flight

Day 1 – Departure and Arrival

- Departure from Cochin International Airport
- Arrival at Singapore Changi Airport
- Meet and greet by tour representative
- Transfer to hotel and check-in
- Evening visit to Marina Bay area and light show
- Overnight stay at hotel

Day 2 – Singapore City Tour

- Breakfast at hotel
- Guided city tour including:
    - Merlion Park
    - Chinatown
    - Little India
    - Orchard Road
- Afternoon shopping and leisure
- Overnight stay at hotel

Day 3 – Sentosa Island Tour

- Breakfast at hotel
- Visit to Sentosa Island
- Activities include:
    - Cable car ride
    - SEA Aquarium
    - Wings of Time show
- Return to hotel
- Overnight stay

Day 4 – Universal Studios

- Breakfast at hotel
- Full-day visit to Universal Studios Singapore
- Enjoy rides, entertainment shows, and attractions
- Shopping and leisure activities
- Overnight stay at hotel

Day 5 – Departure

- Breakfast at hotel
- Check-out from hotel
- Transfer to airport

- Return flight to India
- End of tour

Major Travel Arrangements Included

1. Return airfare
2. Accommodation in 3-star or 4-star hotel
3. Daily breakfast
4. Airport transfers
5. Sightseeing with guide
6. Entry tickets for attractions
7. Travel insurance
8. Visa assistance
9. Local transportation

Tour Cost Includes

- Accommodation
- Transportation
- Meals as mentioned
- Sightseeing charges
- Guide services

Tour Cost Excludes

- Personal expenses
- Extra meals
- Shopping expenses
- Optional activities not mentioned in the itinerary